

A Comparative Study of Work Culture, Job Performance, and Subjective Well-being of Private and Public Sector Banks

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Abstract

The research article compares the work culture (openness, confrontation, trust, authenticity, proactivity, autonomy, collaboration, and experimentation [OCTAPACE]), job performance, and subjective well-being (SWB) as perceived by the employees of private and public sector banks. This research was based on 400 officers and middle-level managers of four private sector banks (Axis Bank, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, and ING Vysya Bank) and four public sector banks (Bank of India, Bank of Baroda, Punjab National Bank, and State Bank of India) from different cities of Uttar Pradesh (Agra, Kanpur, and Lucknow) and Delhi. Using Student's *t*-test (*t*), analysis of variance (ANOVA; *F*-ratio), Pearson product-moment correlation (*r*), and multiple regression (*R*), it was established that the employees of public sector banks scored significantly higher in perceived work culture, job performance, and SWB (and in their respective components) than the employees of private sector banks. A high positive inter-correlation was observed amongst them. Work culture positively influenced job performance and SWB. The biggest determinant of SWB was job performance, and work culture has the least role in it.

Keywords

Work culture (OCTAPACE), job performance, subjective well-being, private and public sector banks

1. Introduction

Banking is a vital and influential unit of national and international economy through global trade, finance and economic planning, agriculture, and other allied activities of the nation including pension, insurance, education loan, public health promotion, and protection. On the basis of focus and work profile, private banks deal with class banking and focus more upon commercial banking with a little focus on the social banking, whereas the public sector banks including cooperative banks deal with mass banking and focus at commercial banking (getting deposits, making advances, loans, credit, and to attract deposits) as well as social banking (government services and promotions). Private banks are owned by individuals and public banks are managed by the government. Their vision, mission, and modus operandi are different. Nevertheless, both types of banks need to work in unison, complementing each other.

Both systems are of vital importance to the country and the customer is the top most priority of these banks.

The productivity of any organization can be reflected by the growth of the organization and its employees. The performance of any organization depends upon the kind of work culture prevailing in the organization. A healthy promoting and supporting work culture can facilitate work, as much as the converse may hamper the performance of organizations. Good work culture enhances job performance (Seibert, Crant, & Kraimer, 1999) and productivity including profitability, branch wise, city wise, and employee wise. Teamwork flourishes when there is prevalence of good work culture. It enhances subjective well-being (SWB) (Mallika & Ramesh, 2010) by exploring and giving the right direction to talents of its employees. A healthy work culture promotes motivation and commitment of employees and boosts group morale. When an employee becomes committed, he becomes passionate

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about his work resulting in good performance and making the employee happy. Conversely, a poor work culture leads to demotivation which in turn causes poor job performance and this may affect the employee's mental health (happiness) adversely.

TV Rao (1981) had coined the concept of OCTAPACE culture, which is an acronym of openness, confrontation, trust, authenticity, pro-activity, autonomy, collaboration, and experimentation, which positively assists in growth of human resource (HR). OCTA means eight and PACE means steps (Pareek, 2000). The eight steps are as follows:

1. O—Openness—It means that employees of an organization are free to express their viewpoint and feelings without any hesitation.
2. C—Confrontation—It means to confront the problem.
3. T—Trust—It is “the willingness of the party to be vulnerable to the actions of another party based on the expectation that the other will perform a particular action important to the trustor, irrespective of the ability to monitor or control that other party” (Mayer et al., 1995).
4. A—Authenticity—It means actual or factual or the way to attain goals, through one's skills, rather than the extent of how much they are achieved. It denotes one's feelings in whatever he says or does.
5. P—Pro-activity—It is defined as “self-initiated and future-oriented action that aims to change and improve the situation or oneself” (Parker, Williams, & Turner 2006).
6. A—Autonomy—It implies freedom without fear. In a way, one is independent to do a task on one's own.
7. C—Collaboration—It denotes working united in a team and with the team.
8. E—Experimentation—It is where an employee tries innovative ideas. This is essential for positive growth of an organization although experimentation involves risk.

In today's scenario, where recession has engulfed the whole world (and India is no exception) and banks have a very crucial role during the financial crisis, OCTAPACE work culture combines a variety of dimensions and positively affects job performance and SWB, if applied appropriately.

2. Review of Literature

This chapter presents the review of relevant literature in the following sequence.

1. *Comparison of Work Culture of Public and Private Banks*: Very few studies were conducted on banks (Vats, 2013; Mahapatra, & Kumar, 2014; Premchandani, 2015). Premchandani (2015) compared private and public banks and reported higher

levels of openness, collaboration, and confrontation in both the banks (SBI and ICICI), moderate levels of trust, experimentation, and pro-activity were found in both banks, authenticity was found to be low in the private bank (ICICI) as compared to the public bank (SBI), and low level of autonomy was reported for both the banks.

2. *Comparison of Job Performance of Public and Private Banks*: Relatively few studies have been conducted on job performance in public and private banks. Other studies on job performance include relation of job performance with job satisfaction (Argyris, 1964; Gross & Etzioni, 1985) and work culture.²³ The studies on job performance in relation with emotional intelligence² and components influencing job performance¹⁰ are few, which have no relevance with the current research.
3. *Comparison of Subjective Well-being of Public and Private Banks*: Research works on SWB with work culture were, namely, Diener, Oishi, and Lucas⁴ and Ogunyemi and Awoyele.²¹ And research on SWB with job performance included the study by Bryson, Forth, and Stokes (2015).

Psychological well-being was reported higher in public banks as compared to private sector banks (Alam & Rizvi, 2012). So, the study favoured public banks when compared to private banks, and psychological well-being is a determinant of SWB.

3. Aims and Objectives

The following are the aims and objectives for the present research.

1. To study and compare the work culture (OCTAPACE), job performance, and SWB prevailing in private and public sector banks.
2. To study how the work culture influences the job performance and SWB of private and public sector bank employees.
3. To find out the inter-correlation between work culture with all variables (job performance and SWB) amongst employees of private and public sector banks.

4. Hypotheses

Keeping in mind the review of literature and aims, in relation to our topic, we have made the following hypotheses.

1. The private and public sector banks differ significantly in the work culture (OCTAPACE) as a whole and in its components.
2. The private and public sector bank employees differ significantly in their job performance and their individual components.

3. The private and public sector bank employees differ significantly in SWB and their individual components.
4. There would be a positive and significant inter-correlation amongst work culture, job performance, and SWB of the private and public sector bank employees.

5. Research Design

The first, second, and third hypotheses stated that public and private banks were significantly different with respect to work culture/job performance/SWB where the independent variable (IV) was banks (private vs public); dependent variable (DV) was work culture/job performance/SWB; quasi-experimental study (ex-post facto study) was the design of study; and the test applied was Student's *t*-test ($p < 0.01$). In this hypothesis itself, work culture influenced job performance and SWB of private and public bank employees. Here, IV was work culture and job performance/SWB was the DV. The design of the study was a 2×2 factorial study and Student's *t*-test with two-way analysis of variance (ANOVA) was applied ($p < 0.01$ for *t*; $p = 0.05$ for *F*-ratio). The next hypothesis was about finding the inter-correlation, that is, positive and significant inter-correlation was found out amongst work culture/job performance/SWB, where this was a correlational study and formula of Pearson product-moment correlation ($p = 0.01$) was applied. Multiple regression (*R*) formula was also applied after correlation. Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS) version 20 was used for output of formulas applied.

6. Sample

Four hundred officers and middle-level managers of four private (Axis Bank, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, and ING Vysya Bank) and four public sector banks (Bank of India, Bank of Baroda, Punjab National Bank, and State Bank of India) from three cities of Uttar Pradesh (namely, Agra, Kanpur, and Lucknow) and Delhi having an experience in bank service for 5 years or more in that particular bank. Sample selection was based on convenience and willingness of the bank employees.

7. Psychological Tools

The tools used for the present research were OCTAPACE questionnaire (Pareek, 1973) (It was used to measure and compare work culture. The split-half reliability of this test was 0.81 and alpha coefficient was 0.90. Validity was indirectly tested by comparing the scores from different departments with their ranking by two judges for their effectiveness at 0.05 level [Mathur, 1991]), job performance scale³⁷ (Reliability—Cronbach's alpha is 0.90. The reliability and validity of this scale can be seen in

many studies³⁷, and Mental Health Continuum Short Form (MHC-SF by Keys 2009). (This scale shows excellent internal consistency [>0.80] and discriminant validity [e.g., Keyes et al., 2008]. The 4-week test-retest reliability estimates ranged from 0.57 for the altogether psychological well-being domain, 0.64 for the overall emotional well-being domain, to 0.71 for the overall social well-being domain.¹³)

8. Statistical Analysis

Statistical techniques used to test the hypotheses were Student's *t*-test (*t*), Pearson product-moment correlation (*r*), two-way ANOVA (*F*-ratio), and multiple regression (*R*). SPSS (Version 20) was used for output.

9. Analyses and Discussion of Results

9.1 Comparison of Work Culture of Private and Public Sector Banks

Hypothesis 1: The private and public sector banks differ significantly in the work culture (OCTAPACE) as a whole and in its components.

From Table 1, it is evident that the total score of work culture (and its components) prevailing in public banks was found to be significantly better than the private banks (mean public bank score = 113.55; mean private bank score = 96.68; [$t = 9.26, p < 0.01$]).

The reasons of work culture being better in public banks rather than private banks (as perceived by employees) (Mittal, 2013) could be as follows:

In public banks, employees have freedom and enjoy independence at work, freely share information (Krishna & Rao, 1997), behave positively (Premchandani, 2015), face challenges (Kumar & Patnaik, 2002), work in team (Bhardwaj & Mishra, 2002), like to experiment (Krishna & Rao, 1997), and are allowed to do so, as compared to employees of private banks where they lack in such openness, confrontation, autonomy, trust, experimentation, authenticity, collaboration, and pro-activeness.

9.1.1 Effect of Good/Poor Work Culture upon Job Performance of Employees of Private and Public Sector Banks

From Table 2, the mean scores of job performance of poor work culture (61.12) and good work culture (69.55) can be observed ($t = -6.72; p < 0.01$). The mean difference of job performance of private and public bank employees was also significant ($t = 11.71; p < 0.01$). The *F*-ratio (5.52) was significant at 0.05 level. Thus, if work culture is good then job performance is also good amongst bank employees and vice versa, that is, if work culture is poor then job performance will also be poor amongst bank employees. Further,

Table 1. Means, SD, *t*- and *p*-values of Work Culture and Its Components

Scale—Work Culture (OCTAPACE)	Public Banks		Private Banks		<i>t</i> -value	<i>p</i> -value
	Mean Score	SD	Mean Score	SD		
Openness	14.96	2.67	13.00	3.28	6.54	0.000
Confrontation	14.26	3.14	11.62	2.67	9.05	0.000
Trust	14.12	2.84	12.95	3.04	3.97	0.000
Authenticity	13.84	2.65	12.82	2.57	3.90	0.000
Pro-activity	14.34	3.29	11.88	3.12	7.66	0.000
Autonomy	13.51	2.46	12.11	2.33	5.85	0.000
Collaboration	14.06	2.68	12.03	2.58	7.17	0.000
Experimentation	14.86	2.69	12.33	2.90	9.03	0.000
Total of all OCTAPACE values	113.55	19.10	96.68	17.24	9.26	0.000

Source: Authors' work.

Note: Number of public sector bank employees = 200; number of private sector bank employees = 200 (total *N* = 400); *p* < 0.01; SD is the standard deviation; *t* is the value after applying Student's *t*-test; and *p* is the level of significance.

Table 2. Means, SD, *t*-, *p*-, and *F*-values of Influence of Good/Poor Work Culture on Job Performance among Private and Public Sector Banks

		Mean	SD	N	t/F	p
Banks	Private	58.87	11.21	200	11.71 (t)	0.000
	Public	72.23	11.58	200		
Work culture	Good work culture	69.55	12.78	210	−6.72 (t)	0.000
	Poor work culture	61.12	12.23	190		
Interaction effect	Type of bank and work culture	5.52 (F) 0.05				

Source: Authors' work.

Note: SD is the standard deviation; *N* is the number of values; and *F* is the value after applying "two-way ANOVA."

the results show that job performance of public bank employees was significantly better than the employees of private bank (*F*-ratio = 5.52) because their work culture was better.

The reasons why work culture influenced job performance (Deal & Kenedy, 1982; Kilmann et al., 1985) could be because good work culture motivated employees to give their best. The common factors of work culture and job performance were helping attitude, belief in employees that they can overcome any challenge, free interaction, one's strengths and weakness come to light, working in team, rotation at job, timely training conducted, encouraged to take risks, and fringe benefits given.

9.1.2 Effect of Good/Poor Work Culture upon Subjective Well-being of Employees of Private and Public Sector Banks

From Table 3, the mean scores of SWB of poor work culture (38.90) and good work culture (44.19) were observed and mean difference was significant (*t* = -4.07; *p* < 0.01). The mean difference of SWB scores of private and public bank sector employees was significant (*t* = 10.62; *p* < 0.01). The *F*-ratio (5.63) was also significant at 0.05 level. Thus, if work culture is good then SWB will also be good amongst bank employees, and if work culture is poor then SWB will also be poor amongst bank employees. Further, the results show that SWB of employees of public

banks was significantly better than the employees of private bank (*F*-ratio = 5.63) because their work culture was better.

The reasons why work culture influenced SWB could be due to innovation (Amabile et al., 2005; George & Zhou, 2007), positive nature, flexibility in intelligence, enthusiasm, and curiosity (Amabile et al., 2005; George & Zhou, 2007).

9.2. Comparison of Job Performance amongst Private and Public Sector Bank Employees

Hypothesis 2: The private and public sector bank employees differ significantly in their job performance and their individual components. (Table 4)

The mean score of job performance of public bank was higher, in comparison to the private banks (mean = 72.23 and 58.87 for public and private banks, respectively; *t* = 11.71; *p* < 0.01).

The possible reasons of job performance being better amongst employees in public banks rather than private banks could be that employees of public banks better understand and complete their duties and take personal interest in issues of other employees as compared to private

Table 3. Means, SD, *t*-, *p*-, and *F*-values of Influence of Good/Poor Work Culture on Subjective Well-being among Private and Public Sector Banks

		Mean	SD	<i>N</i>	<i>t</i> / <i>F</i>	<i>p</i>
Banks	Private	35.47	11.33	200	10.62	0.000
	Public	47.88	12.03	200		
Work culture	Good work culture	44.19	13.41	210	−4.07	0.000
	Poor work culture	38.90	12.47	190		
Interaction effect	Type of bank and work culture	5.63 (<i>F</i>) 0.05				

Source: Authors' work.

Note: SD is the standard deviation and *N* is the number of values.

Table 4. Means, SD, *t*- and *p*-values of Job Performance and Its Components

Scale—Job Performance and Its Components	Public Banks		Private Banks		<i>t</i> -value	<i>p</i> -value
	Mean	SD	Mean	SD		
In-role behaviour (IRB)	23.65	5.44	19.40	4.77	8.31	0.000
Organizational citizenship behaviour directed towards individuals (OCBI)	25.31	4.96	19.66	5.28	11.02	0.000
Organizational citizenship behaviour aimed at the organization (OCBO)	23.39	4.46	19.87	3.93	8.35	0.000
Total of job performance	72.23	11.58	58.87	11.21	11.71	0.000

Source: Authors' work.

Note: Number of public bank employees = 200; number of private bank employees = 200; $p < 0.01$.

sector bank employees who are least concerned with other employees' problems. In private banks, competitive spirit is high (Jain, Sharma, & Jain, 2012) and so private bank employees keep information to themselves, while public bank employees do share any information/knowledge received. In private banks, employees are more literate, are young, and are also well versed with new technology/practices, but still they scored poorly on job performance, as compared to public bank employees who generally lack the MBA degree, but still scored better on job performance (may be due to maturity and more experience in the job). Any health problem⁷ can influence job performance.

9.3 Comparison of Subjective Well-being amongst the Employees of Private and Public Sector Banks

Hypothesis 3: The private and public bank employees differ significantly in SWB and their individual components. (Table 5)

The mean score of SWB in public bank was higher in comparison to private banks (mean = 47.88 and 35.47 for public and private banks, respectively; $t = 10.62$; $p < 0.01$).

The reasons why public banks scored better in SWB than private banks could be salary (Clark, 1999). Despite better salary offered to employees of private banks, their SWB was poor, as compared to public banks, but job security and pension are given to employees of public banks. In addition, work culture with job performance influenced SWB. Personality of an employee influences SWB.⁴ Happy people lead a healthy life (Blanchflower et al., 2013). So in brief, SWB becomes an essential aspect of life.

9.4 Relationship amongst Work Culture, Job Performance, and Subjective Well-being of Private and Public Bank Employees

Hypothesis 4: There would be a positive and significant inter-correlation amongst work culture, job performance, and SWB of private and public bank employees.

Table 5. Means, SD, *t*- and *p*-values of Subjective Well-being and Its Components

Scale—SWB and Its Components	Public Banks		Private Banks		<i>t</i> -value	<i>p</i> -value
	Mean	SD	Mean	SD		
Emotional well-being (EWB)	9.51	4.06	6.84	3.43	7.07	0.000
Social well-being	17.12	4.87	13.02	4.91	8.36	0.000
Psychological well-being (PWB)	21.28	5.36	15.60	5.67	10.29	0.000
Total of SWB	47.88	12.03	35.47	11.33	10.62	0.000

Source: Authors' work.

Note: Number of public bank employees = 200; number of private bank employees = 200; $p < 0.01$.

9.5 Relationship between Job Performance and Work Culture of Private and Public Bank Employees

There was a positive and significant correlation between total of work culture and job performance (0.699), which was at 0.01 level (two-tailed) ($N = 400$).

The reasons for correlation between work culture and job performance amongst (private and public) bank employees could be because work culture was affected by responsibilities of an employee.¹¹ Employees' talent should match job for better and improved performance.¹¹ Pre-planning always helps and positively affects job performance (Seibert, Crant, & Kraimer, 1999).

9.6 Relationship Between Subjective Well-being and Work Culture of Private and Public Bank Employees

The correlation (0.519) between work culture and SWB was positive and significant at 0.01 level (two-tailed) ($N = 400$).

The reasons of correlation could be that a good work culture leads to a person being cheerful and thus leads to positive well-being of the person²¹ and SWB influences persons' health.³ Subjective well-being enhanced innovation (Amabile et al., 2005). Thus, SWB and work culture do share a relationship.

9.7 Relationship between Job Performance and Subjective Well-being of Private and Public Bank Employees

The correlation between total of job performance and SWB (0.701) was positive and significant at 0.01 level (two-tailed) ($N = 400$).

The reasons for correlation between the two could be that if SWB was good then job performance would be positively influenced. Subjective well-being was essential for banking sector as it decreased absenteeism (Peterson et al., 2011) and improved job performance (Peterson et al., 2011).

Multiple regression (R) was calculated to get an idea of the share of work culture and job performance, to account for SWB. Similarly, multiple regression was also calculated to get an idea of the share of work culture and SWB, to account for job performance.

While estimating the relative variance of different IVs accounting for SWB, results showed that job performance was the biggest determinant of SWB (66 per cent) and work culture had the least role in it (3 per cent). The total variance of two factors for SWB was 70 per cent. It was observed in the present study (reported elsewhere) that private and public banks differ significantly in their work culture; nevertheless, the present study reveals that it does not account significantly for SWB of private and public bank employees. Work culture improves job performance

which may in turn improve SWB. Therefore, work culture, as an independent factor, indirectly influences SWB.

Researchers have earlier mentioned in their studies about the relation between work culture and SWB²¹ (Amabile, 2005; George & Zhou, 2007), but have not taken the variable job performance. So, it becomes all the more significant to explore these variables through multiple regression.

While estimating the relative variance of different IVs accounting for job performance, results showed that SWB was the biggest determinant of job performance (46 per cent) and work culture accounted for 30 per cent of variance in job performance of private and public bank employees (officers and middle-level managers). The total variance of two variables for job performance was 80 per cent.

The reasons why work culture contributed in job performance could be proper and timely training conducted and extra benefits given. Subjective well-being contributed to job performance (Lyubmirsky et al., 2005). Thus, all IVs (work culture and SWB) influenced job performance.

All the hypotheses were verified and proved. On the whole, public banks proved to be consistently and significantly better in their work culture, job performance, and SWB. This study throws light on the functional autonomy and good governance prevailing in government banks. It further raises serious questions on the working ethos of private banks, their policies related to employees' health, and SWB. The private banks' work culture, work demands, and working hours reflect greater work strain, more intense job stress, and underplay of human considerations.

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